

Data Day 2027 — Program & Schedule (DRAFT)

Theme: Plotting What's Next — *Five years forward for Central Ohio's data community* **Event:** Data Day 2027 — 5th annual **Date:** Thursday, February 18, 2027 **Venue:** Columbus State Community College, The Conference Center, 315 Cleveland Avenue, 4th floor, Columbus, OH 43215 **Window:** 8:30 AM – 3:45 PM (program content 9:00 AM – 3:45 PM)

Status: **Working draft for discussion.** Layout decisions resolved; remaining venue confirmations noted at the bottom.

Rooms & capacities

Rooms are at Columbus State's Conference Center (315 Cleveland Avenue, 4th floor) — see venue-details.md for the full room list. The four rooms below are **fixed for the whole conference** — the **400 Ballroom's internal A/B/C dividers stay open** all day, so every room is available continuously with no reconfiguration. The **400 Ballroom (full) is set in banquet rounds the entire day** (full rounds): keynotes, ballroom breakouts, the Intern Showcase, and lunch all run from the same round-table setup, so there is never a seating flip.

Room	Capacity	Role in the program
400 Ballroom A-B-C (full)	300 (dining/rounds)	Plenary, both keynotes, Intern Showcase; lecture + panel breakouts
Room 420	64 (classroom)	Technical workshop sessions (hands-on)
Room 412	84 (classroom)	Standard lecture breakouts
Room 414	84 (classroom)	Standard lecture breakouts

Non-session spaces (active all day): the **415 Gallery** hosts **vendor & organization tabling**, and **poster presentations** are displayed throughout the venue's circulation areas. These run continuously and are not scheduled as sessions — see *Throughout the day* below.

Session types

Type	Length	Room(s)	Notes
Keynote	50 min (morning); 55 min (lunch, within lunch block)	400 Ballroom (full)	Morning + lunch
Lecture	45 min	400 Ballroom (full), Room 412, Room 414	Standard breakout
Panel	45 min	400 Ballroom (full)	Moderated, multi-speaker
Workshop	90 min	Room 420	Hands-on/technical; spans 2 breakout blocks
Lightning / Intern Showcase	~5–7 min each (25 min total)	400 Ballroom (full)	Plenary, during lunch

Schedule

Time	400 Ballroom (300)	Room 420 (64)	Room 412 (84)	Room 414 (84)
8:30–9:00	Registration & coffee	—	—	—
9:00–9:10	Welcome & opening (plenary)	—	—	—
9:10–10:00	Morning Keynote	—	—	—
10:00–10:15	<i>Break / transition</i>			
10:15–11:00	Block 1 — Lecture/Panel	Workshop A (90 min, → 12:00)	Block 1 — Lecture	Block 1 — Lecture
11:00–11:15	<i>Break</i>	<i>(workshop continues)</i>	<i>Break</i>	<i>Break</i>
11:15–12:00	Block 2 — Lecture/Panel	Workshop A (cont.)	Block 2 — Lecture	Block 2 — Lecture
12:00–12:15	<i>Break + pick up lunch</i>			
12:15–12:40	Intern Showcase (plenary, while people eat)	—	—	—
12:40–1:35	Lunch Keynote	—	—	—
1:35–1:45	Thank-yous / sponsor recognition / 2028 teaser	—	—	—
1:45–2:00	<i>Break / transition</i>			
2:00–2:45	Block 3 — Lecture/Panel	Workshop B (90 min, → 3:30)	Block 3 — Lecture	Block 3 — Lecture
2:45–3:00	<i>Break</i>	<i>(workshop continues)</i>	<i>Break</i>	<i>Break</i>
3:00–3:45	Block 4 — Lecture/Panel	Workshop B (cont.)	Block 4 — Lecture	Block 4 — Lecture

Lunch block flow (12:00–1:45):

- **Break + pick up lunch** — 15 min

- **Intern Showcase** lightning round while people eat — 25 min
- **Lunch Keynote** as the focused closer — 55 min
- **Thank-yous / sponsor recognition / 2028 teaser** fold in at the end of the keynote — 10 min

(No separate end-of-day closing plenary.)

Throughout the day — exhibits & posters

These run continuously alongside the session grid and use the 415 Gallery and circulation areas, not the four session rooms.

- **Vendor & organization tabling — the 415 Gallery.** Open all day; naturally trafficked during registration (8:30–9:00), every break, and lunch.
- **Poster presentations — throughout the venue.** Displayed all day. Suggest designating **attended poster times** (authors stand by their posters) during the long lunch block and the mid-morning/mid-afternoon breaks so attendees know when to engage.

Two poster/intern pipelines feeding these

1. **Intern projects.** Interns submit their projects for presentation. A selection committee picks **a few for the Intern Showcase lightning talks** (lunch, plenary); the **remaining accepted projects become poster presentations**. One submission pool, two outcomes.
2. **Student poster CFP.** A **separate Call for Proposals for posters from area students** feeds the poster display alongside the intern posters.

Note for the CFP / logistics: both pipelines need submission deadlines, a selection/review step, poster size/format specs, easel or board counts, and assigned display locations. The intern CFP must flag that submitting means *either* a lightning talk *or* a poster.

What this yields

- **2 keynotes** (morning + lunch)
- **1 Intern Showcase** lightning round (plenary, over lunch)
- **14 breakout sessions:**
 - 400 Ballroom (full): 4 (lecture/panel mix)
 - Room 412: 4 lectures
 - Room 414: 4 lectures

- Room 420: 2 workshops (90 min each — one morning, one afternoon)
- **4 concurrent breakout choices** in every block
- **All day:** vendor/organization tabling in the 415 Gallery + poster presentations (intern projects not selected for lightning talks, plus student-CFP posters) throughout the venue

Peak concurrent breakout capacity: $300 + 64 + 84 + 84 = 532$ seats across 4 rooms per block — well above 250 attendance, leaving headroom for popular-session overflow.

Workshop alignment: each 90-min workshop spans both blocks in its half-day and ends exactly when the second lecture block ends, so the grid stays in sync (2 workshops vs. 4 lectures per other room). Workshops run **continuous** through the lecture-room break, with a facilitator-called informal in-room break.

Resolved layout decisions

1. **Ballroom seating: full banquet rounds** all day (max capacity; no seating flip).
2. **Workshops: continuous 90 min** with classroom tables + power and an informal in-room break.
3. **Lunch ordering:** Intern Showcase during eating → Lunch Keynote as closer → thank-yous/extras.
4. **Closing: no separate closing plenary;** recognition folded into the end of the lunch keynote.
5. **Morning start:** registration runs **8:30–9:00**; the morning plenary (welcome + keynote) starts at 9:00.

Remaining venue confirmations

- **Room 420 (workshops):** confirm laptop/classroom tables, power drops, and AV support for hands-on content.
 - **Divider reset:** none required — confirm the 400 Ballroom's A/B/C dividers can simply stay open all day.
 - **Catering timing:** confirm attendees can pick up lunch during the 12:00–12:15 break and be seated for the 12:15 Intern Showcase.
 - **Parking, detailed catering options, and AV rental costs:** not yet confirmed with the venue — see venue-details.md.
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Alternatives worth considering

- **Panels as an anchor:** schedule the ballroom's larger-draw **panels** opposite the workshops so the two "marquee" formats don't compete for the same audience.
- **5-block dense version:** add a breakout block (~20 sessions) if the call for proposals over-subscribes; trades slack for volume.
- **Uniform-45-min fallback:** if 90-min workshops prove hard to fill, run **45-min** workshops in Room 420 (4 total) for a fully uniform grid.